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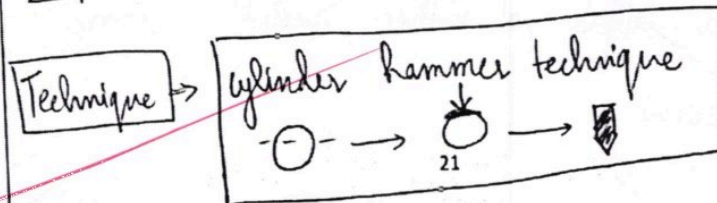
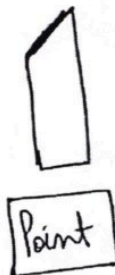
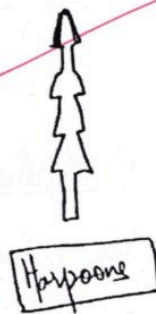
(c) Discuss the characteristics of Upper Paleolithic traditions in India

Paleolithic refers to cultural debris recovered from the Pleistocene era.

Upper Paleolithic tradition aged at 36000-10000 years ago.

Climate ⇒ Northern India (himalayas) faced 4th glacial & inter-glacial while southern India faced pluvial & inter-pluvial climate.

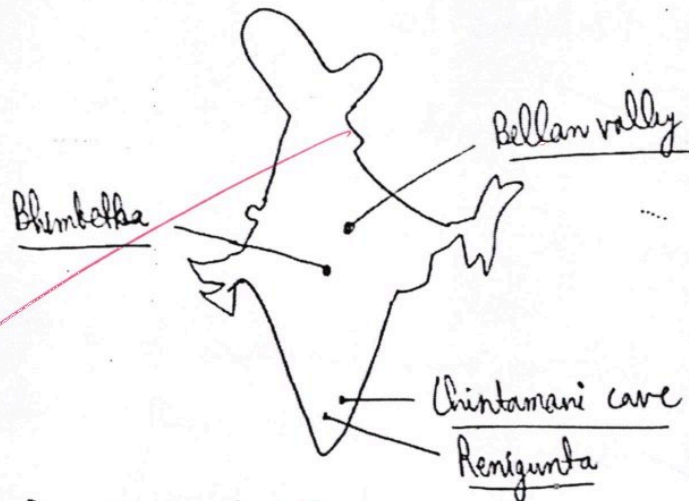
Tools ⇒ material used - quartzite + Bones



Distribution in India

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- 1) Bhimbetka: discovered by VS Wakankar (1967),
cave III F 23 by Prof VN Misra → 8
floors, 4th from top is of upper Paleolithic
Various points and microliths found.
- 2) Muchanta-Chintamani caves: by MLK Murthy
richest bone tool industry in India.
Clear upper paleolithic tradition can
be seen.

- 3) Belan Valley by GR Sharma; various microliths found, along with bone tools.
 - Raised platform with circular stone in which concentric triangles are present.
- 4) Renigunta: variety of bone tools and quartzite tools found. Richest industry in Andhra Pradesh - called treasure house.

Social organisation

- 1) Evidence of rituals from the burials found at Belan valley.
- 2) Cave art and painting at Bhimbelka
- 3) Presence of social organisation from burial patterns.

However, various experts also argued that Indian upper Paleolithic is not as rich as European and African counterparts.